

CAREER PATHS

Most photographers are self-employed and specialize in one area. Creating an online portfolio or website of images and skills, as well as developing both client and industry contacts, helps secure regular work.

ASSISTANT After finishing school, you may be able to gain experience working as an assistant to an established photographer.

GRADUATE A degree in photography or a related arts or design subject is useful, in addition to gaining experience as an assistant.



PHOTOGRAPHER Business acumen and self-promotion is as important to your success as technical and creative skills. You will need to keep up to date with new technology and emerging markets for images.



LIFESTYLE PHOTOGRAPHER
Photographs families, portraits, and events, including weddings, for the general public.



FASHION PHOTOGRAPHER
Takes shots of designers' clothing and accessories to promote fashion brands, especially in magazines. Usually works in a studio or on location.



PRESS PHOTOGRAPHER
Produces photographs of events and the people associated with them, usually for newspapers, magazines, and websites. Often works under pressure to meet deadlines.



MEDICAL PHOTOGRAPHER
Makes photographic records of medical procedures, diseases, injuries, or operations for teaching purposes.



CORPORATE PHOTOGRAPHER
Works in the corporate world to produce images that record or promote an organization's activities or showcase its products and brands to customers.

SKILLS GUIDE



Good artistic and design skills, imagination, and innovative ideas combine to get the best results.



The ability to make people feel comfortable in front of the camera and quickly put them at ease.



Familiarity with computer software and an aptitude with digital photographic equipment.



Strong entrepreneurial spirit and work ethic if freelancing or managing own business.



A good eye for detail, shape, form, and color; high levels of patience and concentration.